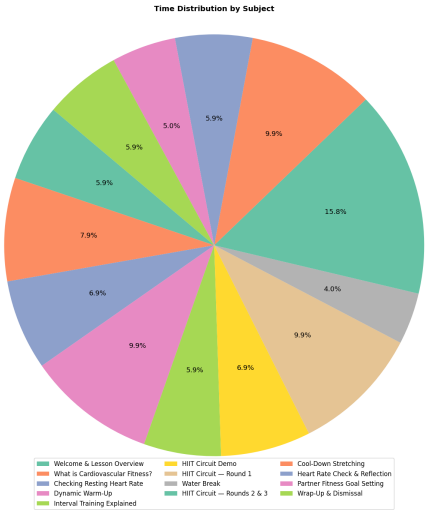
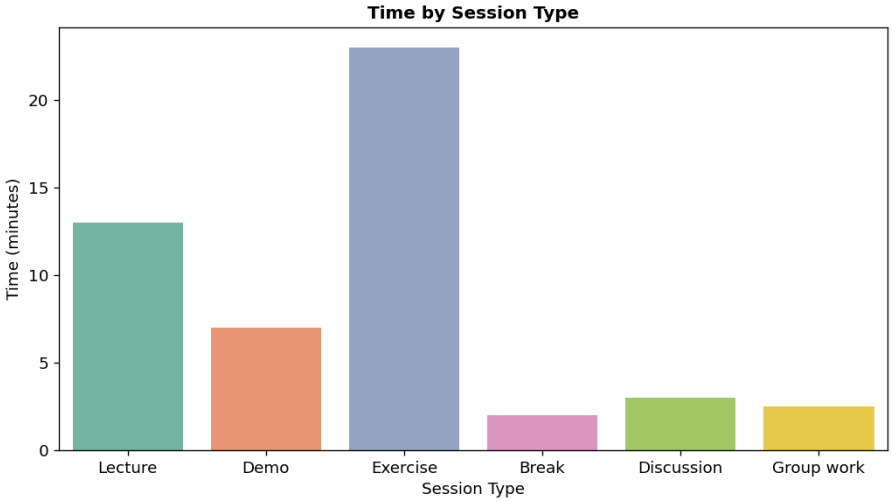
Introduction to Cardiovascular Fitness

Total lesson time: 00:47:30

Lesson Breakdown





Welcome & Lesson Overview

Lecture | Time: 00:03:00

Welcome to PE!

Today we'll be focusing on **cardiovascular fitness** — what it is, why it matters, and how to improve it.

Today's Goals:

1. Understand what cardiovascular fitness means
2. Complete a warm-up routine
3. Learn and practice interval training
4. Cool down safely
5. Reflect on the session as a group

> Make sure you have water and appropriate footwear before we begin!

What is Cardiovascular Fitness?

Lecture | Time: 00:04:00

Cardiovascular Fitness

Cardiovascular fitness refers to the **ability of the heart, lungs, and blood vessels** to deliver oxygen to working muscles during sustained physical activity.

Key Terms:

- **Heart Rate** — beats per minute (BPM)
- **Aerobic Exercise** — activity that raises your heart rate for an extended period
- **VO2 Max** — the maximum rate of oxygen your body can use

Why does it matter?

- Reduces risk of heart disease
- Improves energy levels
- Supports mental health
- Increases endurance

Checking Resting Heart Rate

Demo | Time: 00:03:30

Demo: Finding Your Pulse

Before we get moving, let's establish your **resting heart rate (RHR)**.

How to find your pulse:

1. Place two fingers on the inside of your wrist (radial pulse) **or** the side of your neck (carotid pulse)
2. Count the beats for **30 seconds**
3. Multiply by 2 to get your BPM

Average Resting Heart Rates:

Age Group	Average RHR
Children (6–15)	70–100 BPM
Adults (18+)	60–100 BPM
Athletes	40–60 BPM

> Write down your RHR — we'll compare it after the workout!

Dynamic Warm-Up

Exercise | Time: 00:05:00

Dynamic Warm-Up (5 Minutes)

Let's get the body ready! Follow along with each exercise:

Circuit (45 sec each):

1. **Jogging on the spot**
2. **Arm circles** — forward then backward
3. **High knees**
4. **Leg swings** — front/back and side-to-side
5. **Butt kicks**
6. **Hip rotations**

> Focus on controlled movements — this is a *warm-up*, not a race!

Interval Training Explained

Lecture | Time: 00:03:00

What is Interval Training?

Interval training alternates between periods of high-intensity effort and lower-intensity recovery.

Today's Format — HIIT (High-Intensity Interval Training):

- **Work period:** 40 seconds
- **Rest period:** 20 seconds
- **Rounds:** 3 sets of the full circuit

Benefits:

- Burns more calories in less time
- Improves aerobic *and* anaerobic fitness
- Keeps things interesting!

> Aim to work at **70–85% of your maximum effort** during work periods.

HIIT Circuit Demo

Demo | Time: 00:03:30

Demo: Full Circuit Walkthrough

Before we go full speed, I'll demonstrate each exercise so everyone knows the correct form.

The 5 Exercises:

1. **Jumping Jacks** — arms and legs together
2. **Squat Jumps** — land softly, knees tracking over toes
3. **Mountain Climbers** — keep hips level
4. **Push-Ups** — modify on knees if needed
5. **Burpees** — step version available as a modification

> Modifications are always available — listen to your body!

HIIT Circuit — Round 1

Exercise | Time: 00:05:00

Round 1 — Let's Go!

Complete each exercise for **40 seconds**, then rest for **20 seconds** before moving on.

1. Jumping Jacks
2. Squat Jumps
3. Mountain Climbers
4. Push-Ups
5. Burpees

> Push yourself — but stay in control of your movements!

Water Break

Break | Time: 00:02:00

Water Break — 2 Minutes

Take this time to:
- **Hydrate** — take a good drink of water
- **Catch your breath**
- Walk around slowly to keep blood circulating

> We'll start Round 2 in 2 minutes!

HIIT Circuit — Rounds 2 & 3

Exercise | Time: 00:08:00

Rounds 2 & 3 — Keep It Up!

Same format as Round 1. **40 sec on / 20 sec rest.**

Round 2:

1. Jumping Jacks → Squat Jumps → Mountain Climbers → Push-Ups → Burpees

Short Rest (60 sec)

Round 3:

1. Jumping Jacks → Squat Jumps → Mountain Climbers → Push-Ups → Burpees

> Final round — give it everything you've got!

Cool-Down Stretching

Exercise | Time: 00:05:00

Cool-Down — Static Stretching (5 Minutes)

Slowly bring your heart rate down with these **held stretches** (30 sec each):

1. **Standing quad stretch** — hold ankle, balance on one foot
2. **Hamstring stretch** — seated or standing toe touch
3. **Hip flexor lunge stretch** — deep lunge, back knee down
4. **Chest opener** — clasp hands behind back, open chest
5. **Shoulder cross-body stretch**
6. **Child's pose** — hold for 60 seconds to finish

> Breathe deeply through each stretch. Never bounce — hold steady.

Heart Rate Check & Reflection

Discussion | Time: 00:03:00

Post-Workout Check-In

Let's take our pulse again and compare to our resting heart rate from earlier.

Discussion Questions:

- How does your heart rate now compare to your resting rate?
- Which exercise did you find most challenging? Why?

- How does your body *feel* after the session?
- What would you do differently next time?

> Share with a partner first, then we'll open it up to the group.

Partner Fitness Goal Setting

Group work | Time: 00:02:30

Setting a Fitness Goal

With a partner, use the **SMART goal framework** to set one fitness goal for the next 2 weeks.

SMART Goals:

Letter	Meaning	Example
S	Specific	"I will run 3x per week"
M	Measurable	"For 20 minutes each time"
A	Achievable	"Starting with a walk/run mix"
R	Relevant	"To improve my 1-mile time"
T	Time-bound	"Over the next 2 weeks"

> Write your goal down — you'll review it at our next session!

Wrap-Up & Dismissal

Lecture | Time: 00:03:00

Great Work Today!

What We Covered:

- ☑ Cardiovascular fitness fundamentals
- ☑ Resting heart rate measurement
- ☑ Dynamic warm-up techniques
- ☑ HIIT interval training (3 rounds!)
- ☑ Safe cool-down and stretching
- ☑ SMART goal setting

For Next Class:

- Bring your written SMART goal
- Try to do **one active activity** before we meet again
- Optional: track your steps or active minutes

> See you next time — keep moving!